

— UKG · PARTNER SELECTION · DECISION

Best UKG Partner for Your Implementation? 12 Ways to Compare the Shortlist

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best UKG partner

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/blog/best-ukg-partner-implementation-scorecard

RECOMMENDED SCHEMA

BlogPosting and BreadcrumbList

META DESCRIPTION

The best UKG partner fits your product, workforce, scope, team, and support needs. Use this 12-part scorecard to compare qualified implementation partners.

PRODUCTION NOTE

Preserve the title, direct answer, metadata, factual caveats, sources, and final CTA during the Claude implementation handoff.

FUNNEL / READER INTENT

Decision

DRAFT LENGTH

1,928 words

CONVERSION CTA

Ask Align HCM to review your UKG partner shortlist and implementation scope.

— DIRECT ANSWER

The best UKG partner is the team that can connect the right UKG product to the operating reality of your workforce. Match authorized role, product experience, named people, implementation scope, workforce knowledge, geography, client-side model, and post-go-live support to the decisions your managers, HR, payroll, and operations teams must make.

UKG's Partner Network covers several partner categories, and the UKG Marketplace lets buyers filter by product, region, industry, category, and partner type. Use official sources to qualify a longlist. Then use written scope, scenario interviews, named-team evidence, and comparable references to choose the best fit for the actual work.

— KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Define the UKG product and delivery role before comparing partner names.
- Verify current partner status and relevant product coverage in official UKG sources.
- Interview the named delivery team, not only the sales team.
- Score payroll, workforce management, data, integration, testing, training, and post-go-live depth against your real scope.
- Compare partner proposals with one responsibility matrix and one set of assumptions.

Why industry fit matters in a UKG partner shortlist

Industry fit is not a badge. It is the ability to connect UKG decisions to the coverage, rules, time, pay, cost, and employee outcomes the operation depends on.

OPERATING ENVIRONMENT	EVIDENCE THE PARTNER OR PLAN SHOULD ADDRESS
Healthcare	Ask the proposed team to work through a coverage change involving qualifications, differentials, approvals, and the payroll consequence across facilities or units.
Manufacturing	Use a line or shift-change scenario involving skills, certifications, labor rules, transfers, overtime, and labor-cost visibility.
Retail & Hospitality	Use a multi-location demand scenario involving availability, mixed worker groups, transfers, premiums, manager workflow, and the customer or guest experience.
Services & Distribution	Use a route, warehouse, or mobile-service scenario involving coverage, handoffs, travel, overtime, approvals, and delivery commitments.
Public Sector	Test collective bargaining agreements, civil-service or union rules where applicable, complex schedules, budget controls, audit trails, accessibility and security requirements, public accountability, and continuity of essential services.

Score the quality of the team's questions and reasoning, not whether it recites an industry label. The scenario should reveal how the partner connects platform expertise to operational judgment.

What does “best UKG partner” mean?

For an implementation buyer, “best” should mean best fit across four layers:

- 1 **Platform fit:** The partner supports the UKG product and modules in your scope.

- 2 **Operating fit:** The team understands how your payroll, time, scheduling, HR, talent, finance, and frontline processes work.
- 3 **Delivery fit:** The proposed people, method, location, capacity, and commercial model suit the project.
- 4 **Lifecycle fit:** The partner can help the organization move from implementation into stable ownership, support, and optimization.

A ranking based only on company size, brand recognition, or total certifications cannot answer all four.

That matches the software-selection literature. [Jadhav and Sonar's review of package evaluation methods](#) finds that defensible selections rest on explicit, weighted criteria applied identically to every candidate, rather than on reputation or a holistic impression.

Start with the right UKG partner category

UKG distinguishes several partner roles. The implementation buyer should confirm whether a candidate is being considered for consulting, implementation, integration, resale, a technology extension, or another service.

NEED	PARTNER QUESTION
Implementation or consulting	Does the firm support our UKG product, modules, industry, region, and delivery scope?
Integration or technology	Is the connection listed or validated for the relevant UKG product, and who supports it after launch?
Reseller relationship	Which party owns the software relationship, implementation, and ongoing support?
Client-side leadership	Who represents the customer's operating needs and drives internal work?
Post-go-live support	Which services, response model, staffing, and optimization capabilities continue after launch?

The UKG Marketplace describes services partners as providers of setup, training, support, implementation, and consulting services. That description is broad. Your statement of work must still identify exactly what the selected partner owns.



A useful UKG partner interview tests the proposed team, scope ownership, and reasoning against the same questions. Original Align HCM illustration.

The 12-part best UKG partner scorecard

Score each area from 1 to 5 and record the evidence behind the score. Adjust weights before proposals are opened so the project does not change the rules to favor a familiar name.

1. Current UKG relationship and product coverage

Confirm the candidate's current listing or relationship through an official UKG source. Verify the exact products and services it supports. Do not assume that UKG experience in one product or legacy environment transfers automatically to every current scope.

2. UKG product fit

Ask for relevant work in UKG Pro, UKG Ready, UKG Pro Workforce Management, or the specific products in your plan. The partner should explain how the product choice changes implementation decisions, client effort, testing, and support.

3. Payroll and workforce-operations depth

Have the proposed team walk through a real pay-period, time-approval, scheduling, or exception scenario. Strong answers connect system decisions to operating controls, manager behavior, and issue resolution.

4. Industry and workforce fit

Complex hourly, union, multi-state, public-sector, healthcare, manufacturing, retail, hospitality, or global workforces can place different demands on configuration, compliance, change, and support. Similar operating complexity matters more than a generic logo slide.

5. Named delivery team

Compare the people who will perform the work. Review their roles, product and functional experience, availability, location, continuity, and expected allocation. Ask how replacements are handled.

6. Discovery and scope discipline

The partner should translate outcomes into modules, populations, workflows, data, integrations, security, reports, testing, training, cutover, and support. Look for clear deliverables, assumptions, exclusions, acceptance criteria, and change rules.

7. Client-side operating model

UKG's own implementation guidance emphasizes active customer participation. Ask how the partner organizes decision makers, data owners, testers, trainers, sponsors, and business stakeholders. If your team lacks capacity, confirm whether client-side support is included or separately available.

Peer-reviewed ERP research points the same way: Umble, Haft and Umble identify project-management discipline, data accuracy, and extensive user training as critical success factors, all of which depend on customer capacity rather than vendor effort.

8. Data and integration approach

Request the migration method, reconciliation plan, integration design standard, failure-handling process, and ownership after launch. The partner should be able to discuss both technical movement and business control.

9. Testing and readiness

Ask how test scenarios are created, which business users participate, how defects are governed, what must be retested, and who signs off. A launch date without visible exit criteria is not a readiness plan.

10. Training and adoption

Compare role-based learning for employees, managers, HR, payroll, administrators, and operations leaders. Confirm whether training uses your configured environment and whether editable source materials transfer to your team.

11. Go-live and post-go-live support

Require a hypercare model, severity process, coverage window, transition plan, documentation handoff, and ongoing support options. UKG's implementation guidance treats continuous improvement and post-go-live support as part of success, not an afterthought.

12. Reference and review quality

Use UKG Marketplace review links and direct references. Ask references about team continuity, scope control, data, testing, communication, change orders, go-live, and support. Favor comparable complexity over broad praise.

A 100-point UKG partner comparison

CATEGORY	WEIGHT	CANDIDATE SCORE
Current relationship and exact product coverage	10	
Product and module experience	10	
Payroll and workforce-operations depth	15	
Industry, geography, and workforce fit	10	
Named delivery team	10	
Scope and commercial clarity	10	
Client-side operating model	10	
Data and integrations	10	
Testing, training, and change readiness	10	
Hypercare, support, and references	5	
Total	100	

Do not let the total hide a critical failure. A partner that cannot support the required UKG product, payroll risk, geography, security need, or implementation role should not pass because it scored well elsewhere.

How to build the shortlist

- 1 Define the product and work.** State the UKG products, modules, populations, locations, integrations, timeline, and service model.
- 2 Search official UKG sources.** Filter for the relevant products, services, industries, and regions.
- 3 Create a longlist.** Record current listing evidence, service scope, product coverage, public references, and review sources.
- 4 Issue one request.** Give every candidate the same facts, questions, and response format.
- 5 Interview the delivery team.** Use two real scenarios from your payroll or workforce operations.
- 6 Normalize proposals.** Compare ownership, deliverables, assumptions, exclusions, client effort, and post-go-live coverage.
- 7 Check references.** Speak with organizations that resemble your project.

- 8 **Document the decision.** Preserve the score, evidence, risks, and conditions that support the final choice.

Red flags in a “best UKG partner” claim

- The claim is not tied to a product, service, region, industry, or buyer need.
- Awards or certifications replace a discussion of the proposed team.
- The proposal promises outcomes without explaining client responsibilities.
- UKG experience is described broadly, with no distinction among products or modules.
- Data, integrations, testing, training, or post-go-live work are vague.
- References do not match the workforce or project complexity.
- The timeline is promised before discovery.
- The partner cannot explain how it handles scope change or team turnover.

Why Align HCM belongs on the shortlist

Align HCM supports organizations across UKG implementation, client-side leadership, data, integrations, testing, training, go-live, stabilization, and ongoing improvement. Explore the Align HCM UKG page, [implementation services](#), and [client-side HCM project support](#).

For a practical example, see how AWP migrated from UTM to UKG Dimensions with Align HCM.

The right next step is not to accept any firm's “best” claim. It is to compare the fit. [Contact Align HCM](#) for a free, no-obligation assessment of your UKG scope, internal capacity, partner shortlist, or active implementation plan.

Frequently asked questions

Q Who is the best UKG partner?

There is no universal best UKG partner for every organization. The best fit depends on the UKG product, modules, implementation role, workforce complexity, industry, geography, internal capacity, delivery team, commercial model, and post-go-live needs.

Q Where can I find official UKG partners?

Start with the UKG Partner Network and UKG Marketplace. Use current product, service, industry, region, and partner-type filters, then verify the specific listing and scope before treating a firm as qualified for your project.

Q What should I ask a UKG implementation partner?

Ask about exact product coverage, named team, payroll and workforce experience, industry fit, discovery, data, integrations, testing, training, client responsibilities, cutover, hypercare, support, assumptions, exclusions, change control, and comparable references.

Q Is the largest UKG partner always the safest choice?

No. Scale can provide capacity and breadth, but it does not guarantee fit, team continuity, senior involvement, or a delivery model suited to your organization. Compare the named team and scope alongside firm-level credentials.

Q Can Align HCM help us compare UKG partners?

Align HCM offers assessments and client-side services that can help an organization clarify scope, ownership, readiness, and partner-fit criteria. The exact review should be agreed in advance, and confidential materials should use an approved secure channel.

Conversion CTA

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[Talk to an Align HCM expert](#)

● PUBLICATION NOTES

Recommended internal links: UKG partner page, implementation services, client-side services, integration services, data conversion, training, support, a comparable UKG case study, the UKG buyer guide, and contact. Add the Industry Solutions hub and one matching sector page only after their production alignhcm.com URLs are live.

Recommended schema: BlogPosting and BreadcrumbList. Keep the visible FAQ and shortlist steps for readers and answer engines, but do not use FAQPage or HowTo rich-result markup because Google no longer displays those rich results. Do not use Review or AggregateRating schema unless the visible page contains eligible first-party review content and implementation is approved.

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● SOURCES

- **UKG Partner Network**
- **UKG Marketplace help and partner-selection filters**
- **UKG: How to Ensure HCM Implementation Success**
- **UKG: Getting on Track, 5 Tips for a Successful HCM Implementation**
- **Align HCM UKG services**
- **Align HCM strategic buyer's guide to UKG**
- **Align HCM client-side services**
<https://www.alignhcm.com/services/client-side-services>
- **Align HCM case study: AWP migrates to UKG Dimensions**

● RESEARCH SOURCES

Peer-reviewed and published research cited inline above. Every DOI was verified to resolve to the cited article.

- Jadhav, A. S., & Sonar, R. M. (2009). Evaluating and selecting software packages: A review. *Information and Software Technology*, 51(3), 555–563.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.infsof.2008.09.003>
- Umble, E. J., Haft, R. R., & Umble, M. M. (2003). Enterprise resource planning: Implementation procedures and critical success factors. *European Journal of Operational Research*, 146(2), 241–257.
[https://doi.org/10.1016/S0377-2217\(02\)00547-7](https://doi.org/10.1016/S0377-2217(02)00547-7)